

of Greenwich, CT, which I designed to fit my taste and feel like a hobby; a combination of an applied probability research laboratory, athletic summer camp, and, not least, a crisis hunting hedge fund operation (I had experienced one of my best professional years while writing these lines). I thank all the like-minded people who helped fuel the stimulating atmosphere there: Pallop Angsupun, Danny Tosto, Peter Halle, Mark Spitznagel, Yuzhang Zhou, and Cyril de Lambilly as well as the members of Paloma Partners such as Tom Witz who challenged our wisdom on a daily basis or Donald Sussman who supplied me with his penetrating judgment.

CHAPTER SUMMARIES



One: If You're So Rich Why Aren't You So Smart?

An illustration of the effect of randomness on social pecking order and jealousy, through two characters of opposite attitudes. On the concealed rare event. How things in modern life may change rather rapidly, except, perhaps, in dentistry.

Two: A Bizarre Accounting Method

On alternative histories, a probabilistic view of the world, intellectual fraud, and the randomness wisdom of a Frenchman with steady bathing habits. How journalists are bred to not understand random series of events. Beware borrowed wisdom: how almost all great ideas concerning random outcomes are against conventional sapience. On the difference between correctness and intelligibility.

Three: A Mathematical Meditation on History

On Monte Carlo simulation as a metaphor to understanding a sequence of random historical events. On randomness and artificial history. Age is beauty, almost always, and the new and the young are generally toxic. Send your history professor to an introductory class on sampling theory.

Four: Randomness, Nonsense, and the Scientific Intellectual

On extending the Monte Carlo generator to produce artificial thinking and compare it with rigorous non-random constructs. The science wars enter the business world. Why the aesthete in me loves to be fooled by randomness.